Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · GROW · Spring 2 Week 3 · Wednesday 10 March 2027 · P5

Lesson

Refine and share a story about change

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Devise a short performance about overcoming change.

Today I can

I can keep a clear change and response in our scene.

I can improve one performance feature.

I can record feedback and my own contribution.

Prepare

For up to five pupils: books or arts logs and pencils.

Clear personal spaces or seats for hand-gesture performance. All props and spaces in the story are imagined.

Read the two fictional performance cards aloud. Use an adult-written four-beat outline if needed.

Bring previous outlines and genuine trial feedback if available. If absent or missing, create a fresh trial today. Keep individual contribution records separate from the group outline.

Cover route

Retrieve the four-beat smaller-space scene or make a fresh dated trial from the Starter. Choose one target using actual feedback. Model testing one feature. Rehearse, share with an agreed small audience, ask what changed and what helped, then record actual feedback and each pupil's own contribution. No audience beyond a trusted adult, prior work or device is required.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: We will improve one part of our invented scene. Choose a peer, small group or trusted adult as audience. If work is missing or you were absent, use the four-beat story and make a fresh version today. Do not add an earlier date to new evidence.

Look for: Pupil retrieves a genuine starting point or begins a fresh dated attempt and confirms an accessible role.

Fallback: Read the four beats from the Starter and let the pupil choose one to direct.

Check and response: A fresh attempt is valid. It must not be described as a performance that happened in the previous lesson.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: In our story the space gets smaller. The response is the group asking for ideas and trying small moves. What did our watcher actually notice? If we have no feedback yet, I will watch a brief trial now and describe one thing I see. Choose one useful target.

Look for: Pupil distinguishes event from response and chooses one target grounded in a genuine observation.

Fallback: Offer two visible targets: hold the choice pose longer or give a clear silent cue.

Check and response: The change is smaller space. The response is the new plan. A target should help the audience see that link.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: First I rush through the new idea. Now I pause, ask What could we try? and repeat a small move once. For this test I am changing the pause length only. Tell me if that gives the audience time to see the choice. A later test could change the cue, but we will not change everything at once.

Look for: Adult models controlled refinement and an audience check. Pupil links the tested feature to clarity.

Fallback: Use one hand gesture and a counted silent pause. Pupil chooses the shorter or longer pause.

Check and response: Holding a pause can mark thinking and separate the change from the new plan. A shorter pause may be preferred if the group can still make the choice clear.

We do 6 minutes

Say: Use one kind specific comment: I could see ... when ... . Makers, decide whether to keep the tested change. Feedback informs your choice; it does not take the choice away from you. Make sure every pupil has a real creative contribution and knows the stop cue.

Look for: Group tests one feature and makes an evidence-based decision. Watcher comment is precise and maker confirms the choice.

Fallback: Adult watches a seated trial and gives one concrete observation; pupil chooses keep or change.

Check and response: Example: I could see the decision when you held the offered move before copying it. The group might keep that hold because it makes agreement visible.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Use five minutes to rehearse and three to share with the chosen small audience. Use two minutes for the audience questions and four for individual logs. A private directed demonstration is valid. Watchers describe features and keep comments kind. Keep sound below speaking level and all movement within each person's own space.

Look for: Short performance or directed scene clearly shows a change and response. Each pupil retains an individual account of their contribution, real feedback and a next step.

Fallback: Use four seated hand poses and adult narration. The pupil directs the improved cue or pause, and a trusted adult watches privately.

Check and response: Example only: I changed the cue from a spoken Next to a held hand. The watcher saw us start the new move together. I will keep that cue and next work on a clear final pose.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Ask each maker to confirm their own part. If the audience missed a beat, keep that as useful feedback rather than pretending it worked. No rating of confidence or personal disclosure is needed. Use the last two minutes for calm storage and clearing the space.

Look for: Reflection compares intention and audience reading honestly, including an unfinished feature if relevant.

Fallback: Adult reads back a brief observation and asks pupil to confirm or correct the own-contribution record.

Check and response: Useful reflection: The audience saw the smaller space but missed the request for help. Our next step is to hold the choice beat longer.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Date the log and record actual support. Keep the first attempt and this later version if possible. Your arts log can show useful change even when the scene is still in rehearsal. This is evidence towards the award, not a claim that all its requirements are complete.

Look for: Dated reflection records a specific before-and-after feature, real feedback and an honest next step.

Fallback: Pupil points to the changed beat and confirms an adult-written record. Record what was observed, not an inferred feeling.

Check: Example only: I directed a longer pause. The watcher saw the new plan clearly. Next I will practise giving the final cue without an adult prompt.

Evidence and review

Retain a dated sequence sketch or cue record, a brief adult observation of the real performance or rehearsal, and each pupil's own confirmed arts-log words. Record the contribution, change and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional under local consent procedures. Never enter a teacher model as pupil work.

Misconceptions

We must accept every suggestion - Listen, test and choose what fits the intended story. Explain the decision.

Sharing means performing to a whole class - A chosen peer or trusted adult can be the audience. A directed or seated scene is valid.

Feedback must say the performance was perfect - Honest specific feedback supports a useful next step. Record what actually happened.

Questions

foundation: Which part comes first?

middle: Which cue helps the next part start?

higher: How does the last pose show the new plan has worked?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Check a clear personal space before any movement. Walk only; no running, lifting, falling, climbing, throwing or actual building. Keep all imagined props imaginary. Use an agreed open-hand stop cue. Do not move another pupil or their chair.

Emotional and sensory access

Use invented situations. No personal accounts, surprise noise, touch, contact, shouting or forced eye contact. Offer seated movement, silent gesture, narrator or director roles. Pupils may share with a trusted adult only. Agree a calm place and a return cue before starting.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Show one story beat at a time. Rehearse three or four beats with concrete cue words. Model the first pose, then fade the adult lead. Check the pupil can point to the next beat.

Communication And Interaction: Offer pointing, signing, a narrator line, directing or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ... because ... and First ... next ... last ... .

Semh: Keep the event fictional and low stakes. Agree roles with pupils. Allow a pause, role change or private audience. Praise a specific contribution rather than confidence or compliance.

Sensory And Physical: Perform from a chair, use hands only or direct an adult. Avoid unexpected sound and touch. Ensure personal space. A silent cue is valid.

Eal: Plan in any language. Pair story cues with gestures. Accept oral rehearsal or a labelled sketch. Check the intended story order rather than accent or spelling.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. Each lesson is complete without the optional GROW next level stretch. Keep records for the award; these lessons alone do not complete or certify it.

Resilience can include pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying a manageable next step. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or continuing through pain.

Optional next level stretch

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Task

Compare your plan with what the viewer saw. Which part showed the change best? Use a real detail. Say why you will keep or change one part. Plan a way to check your next skill goal.

Evidence

Keep your plan, your own part and real feedback. Add your choice and reason. Add a skill goal and a way to check it.

Optional scope

This may support later next level review. It is optional, adds no requirement to today's Explore task, and does not itself complete the award.

Support

Pupil links a skill change to evidence from trials, considers the audience reading and sets a specific manageable next step.

Adult asks what changed and reads back the pupil's own words. Pupil confirms one next practice action.